

# Module 4

## Healthy Relationship



## Module 4 Healthy Relationships

### Background

The module is designed to provide comprehensive insights into the essential components that foster well-being and harmony in personal and community interactions. This module discusses important aspects such as Family Mental Health, Counseling Skills, Civic Sense, and Responsible Citizenship.

### Family Mental Health

This session emphasizes the importance of nurturing a healthy mental state for all family members. It provides practical strategies e.g. Mindful Breastfeeding Exercise, which highlights how mindful practices can create a calming and bonding experience for both mother and child. It discusses strategies including Yoga, Meditation, and Religious Practices, which have been shown to reduce stress, enhance emotional regulation, and promote overall well-being.

### Relationship Skills

This part explores Temperament and how it shapes reactions and interactions, followed by strategies for Conflict Resolution to manage and resolve disputes constructively. The session will address Common Behavior Problems, offering insights and interventions. It also highlights the issues of Intolerance and Incivility, promoting tolerance and respect in interactions. Lastly, the session discusses Self-Reliance and Personal Strengths, empowering individuals to recognize and build on their capabilities to develop resilience and confidence.

### Civic Sense and Responsible Citizenship

This session explores the concept of Civic Sense, which includes behaviors and attitudes such as respecting public spaces and following laws. It also emphasizes the importance of a Sense of Community Responsibility, encouraging active participation in local initiatives, volunteering, and promoting social cohesion.

Through this module, participants will gain a deeper understanding of the importance of family mental health and be equipped with practical tools and exercises to foster a supportive and healthy home environment promote overall well-being and social harmony, and contribute to their communities as active, informed citizens.

### 4.1. Family Mental Health

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| <b>Name of the Session</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Family Mental Health |
| <b>Time</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | 155 minutes          |
| <b>Learning Outcomes</b><br>By the end of this session, participants will be able to: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Explore how daily stress and emotions contribute to mental health issues.</li> <li>• Realize the impact of family environment on children's mental health.</li> <li>• Discuss the reasons for mental health issues arising in families.</li> <li>• Identify strategies that can support individuals cope with stress and anxiety</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                      |
| <b>Sessions Resources/ Materials</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Basic stationery</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                      |
| <b>Concepts/ Themes to be Covered</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Mental health issues</li> <li>• Impact of mental health issues on the family environment</li> <li>• Impact of mental health issues on children's mental health</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                      |
| <b>Activity 1: Mindful Breathing Exercise (15 minutes)</b><br><b>Instructions</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Invite the participants to sit on the mat in a big circle.</li> <li>• Explain briefly about the importance of breathing exercises to the participants and tell them we are going to do the breathing exercise.</li> <li>• Sit in a comfortable position with your back straight (if the participants are sitting on a chair, then their feet should be flat on the floor.)</li> <li>• Ask participants to close their eyes.</li> <li>• Now play calm and relaxing music and ask the participants to follow the instructions.               <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ Breathe in through your nose counting 4. As you breathe in, feel your chest filling up with air and observe your shoulders rising and your tummy expanding.</li> <li>○ Hold your breath counting 4 and concentrate on the fullness in your chest and tummy.</li> <li>○ While you breathe out, scan your body from top to bottom.</li> <li>○ Now slowly breathe out through your mouth counting 4 and as you breathe out, focus on your forehead, then your chest, tummy, knees, and feet, and relax. Return to your regular breathing pattern and repeat 2 to 3 times.</li> </ul> </li> <li>• Tell the participants that breathing exercise is one of the ways to stay calm and relaxed. It can be done anytime.</li> </ul> |                      |

**Activity 2: Family Mental Health (40 minutes)****Instructions**

- Ask participants the following questions.
  - What is the one thing that brings a smile to your face, no matter how challenging your days have been?
  - How do you care for yourself and get relaxed?
  - How conscious you are about your family's health, both physical and mental?
  - What is mental health and how important is it?
- Ask them to reflect and share their responses.
- Take maximum responses and explain the concept of mental health with the help of the facilitator's notes.

**Facilitator's Notes**

Mental health is a state of well-being in which an individual can cope with everyday life stresses, work productivity, and contribute to their community. An individual with good mental health can think clearly, solve problems, maintain positive relationships, feel at ease spiritually, and make valuable contributions to society. Mental health is a fundamental human right for personal, community, and socio-economic development. Mental health conditions encompass mental disorders, psychosocial disabilities, and other states of mental well-being characterized by considerable distress, impaired functioning, or a potential risk of self-harm.



Nevertheless, mental health extends beyond the mere absence of mental disorders. It resides on an intricate spectrum, uniquely perceived by individuals, marked by diverse levels of challenge and distress.

**Activity 2: Mental Health Issues (40 minutes)****Instructions**

- Divide the participants into groups.
- Ask the groups to discuss and share the key factors that contribute to mental health issues.
- Invite the groups one by one and ask them to present their work.
- Discuss the bio-psychological model with the help of the facilitator's notes.

**Facilitator's Notes****Factors that cause problems in mental health:**

- Poor lifestyle choices, such as inactive lifestyles or unhealthy eating habits, can negatively impact physical health.
- Unavailability of healthcare services, including preventive care and regular check-ups can influence physical well-being.
- Living conditions, exposure to pollutants, and the overall environment can impact physical health.

- Balance between work responsibilities and personal life is crucial for physical and mental well-being.
- Traumatic events, abuse, or adverse childhood experiences can have a lasting impact on mental well-being.
- Chronic stress, due to poverty, chronic health issues, etc., poor stress management, and unhealthy lifestyle choices (e.g., substance abuse) can contribute to mental health issues.
- The demands and challenges of parenting, especially during early years, can impact mental health. Sleep deprivation, adjusting to new roles, and balancing responsibilities contribute to parental stress.
- The absence of a strong support system, including family and friends, can influence mental well-being.



### Activity 3: Strategies to Improve Mental Health (50 minutes)

#### Instructions

- Ask the participants to share strategies that can enhance and improve mental health.
- Share and practically demonstrate some of the strategies given in the facilitator's notes.

#### Facilitator's Notes

- Dedicate time for self-care activities that bring joy and relaxation e.g., writing a diary, drawing, gardening, etc.
- Practice mindfulness activities such as yoga, meditation / religious activities, prayers, or deep breathing exercises.
- Consume a balanced and nutritious diet.
- Ensure adequate and quality sleep.
- Practice open communication with a trusted friend and family member.
- Engaging in volunteering can provide a sense of purpose and contribute to positive mental health.
- Set clear boundaries in personal and professional relationships to maintain a healthy balance.
- Practice gratitude by regularly acknowledging and appreciating positive aspects of life.
- Gain knowledge about mental health, understand common stressors, and learn coping strategies to overcome challenges more effectively.



- Watch a favourite TV show/ go watch a movie.
- Prioritize self-care.
- Develop and nurture hobbies according to interest e.g. play a musical instrument, sing / listen to music, nature walks, socializing activities etc.
- Spiritual growth is part of a child's right, and it is important to teach religion and spirituality to the children. This should be done in a sensitive manner avoiding force and punishment as children learn by observing their adults. It is needed to model such behaviors. In addition, children should be allowed to ask questions for clarity and give space for open conversations, etc.



#### Activity 4: Conclusion: Count your Blessings (10 minutes)

##### Instructions

- Provide the participants with a colorful paper.
- Ask them to sit back, relax, and think about all the blessings the Creator has blessed them with, e.g., good health, kids, love, parents, even the breath they are taking.
- Ask them to write all on the paper and decorate the paper as per their creativity.
- Invite a few participants to share their list.
- At the end, ask the participants to daily count their blessings and thank to Almighty for all His blessings.

**Note:** Participants of group two will draw their blessings or will write in the language they are comfortable with.

#### Key Takeaways: Family Mental Health

- Mental health involves recognizing and addressing the emotional needs and coping process of each member of the family.
- Providing emotional support within the family is essential for maintaining good mental health.
- Open communication develops understanding, empathy, and mutual support among family members.
- Families with strong mental health are equipped with coping mechanisms to deal with life's challenges. This may include problem-solving and resilience.
- Measures such as promoting mental health awareness, seeking professional help when needed and addressing issues early on, are essential components of family mental health.
- Recognizing and celebrating achievements fosters a positive atmosphere within the family.

## 4.2. Relationship Skills

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| <b>Name of the Session</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Relationship Skills |
| <b>Time</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 325 minutes hours   |
| <b>Learning Outcomes</b><br>By the end of this session, participants will be able to: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Identify the impact of family conflicts on child personality development.</li> <li>• Discuss different types of conflicts children face in their early years.</li> <li>• Identify child conflict resolution techniques.</li> <li>• Explore reasons for unaccepted behaviour and ways to respond to such behaviours.</li> <li>• Find out ways to develop healthy relationships for a child's optimal development.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                |                     |
| <b>Sessions Resources/ Materials</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Basic stationery</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                     |
| <b>Concepts/ Themes to be Covered</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Safe self-Disclosure</li> <li>• Resolving Conflicts</li> <li>• Temperament and Conflict in Early Years</li> <li>• Minimizing Intolerance and Incivility</li> <li>• Boosting Self-Reliance Attitudes</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                     |
| <b>Activity 01: Self-Disclosure (40 minutes)</b><br><b>Instructions</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Allow participants to choose their pairs.</li> <li>• Have one person share a personal experience while the other actively listens.</li> <li>• Afterward, switch the roles.</li> <li>• Let a few pairs share the experience in a large group.</li> <li>• Explain to participants that <b>Self-disclosure</b> refers to the act of revealing personal information, thoughts, feelings, or experiences to others. It involves sharing aspects of oneself with others in an intentional manner. Self-disclosure can occur in various relationships and contexts, such as friendships, and family.</li> </ul> |                     |

**Activity 02: Self-Awareness (60 minutes)****Instructions**

- Provide tempo markers and A4 size paper to each participant.
- Ask them to fold the paper into four sections and then unfold it.
- Tell participants to number each section, 1 to 4.
- Tell them that in this activity you have the choice to either draw or write.
- Start the activity by giving the following instructions.
  - Section 1- Draw or write information about you that both you and others know.
  - Section 2- Draw or write information about you that you don't know but others know.
  - Section 3- Draw or write information about you that you know but others don't know.
  - Section 4- Draw or write information about you that neither you nor others know.
- The activity will allow the participants to gain awareness about themselves.
- Randomly ask a few participants to share their responses with the group.
- Encourage the participants to replicate the same with their children as well with the help of the facilitator's notes.

**Notes:** For group two, the participants can be asked to either think and share their responses verbally or could be asked to draw their responses and share them with a large group.

**Facilitator's Notes**

During the early childhood years, children are very open and innocent as they have not yet learned how to control the information they share. Pretend play helps them to share information on how they perceive matters in a family setting. This discloses their perceptions, feelings, and intentions. As they develop communication skills, they can disclose and share using verbal and nonverbal language. With peer interaction, they learn why, how, and when to keep information private. Parents also guide them on what to share and what not to share with others, especially strangers. This is part of their learning process. Children start anticipating which behaviour will be approved or disapproved based on their observation of parental behaviour in the past in a given context. For fear of punishment, shaming, and rejection, they may stop disclosing certain information and keep it private.

**Activity 03: Temperament (30 minutes)****Instructions**

- Ask the participants to share their understanding of the word temperament.
- Take a few responses and explain the concept with the help of notes.
- Pose the given question and ask the participants to think and share.

- Can you think about any child that you know who demonstrates very different temperaments?
- Take a few responses, note the answers on the board, and then explain temperament and conflict in early years with the help of the facilitator's notes.

### Facilitator's Notes

Temperament describes how babies react to the world around them. All babies are born ready for social interaction, and each comes with its way of behaving or temperament.

“Temperament refers to individual characteristics that influence how we react emotionally, cognitively, and physically in various situations.”

Temperament affects babies' moods and emotions, how they approach and react to situations, and their level of fear, frustration, sadness, and discomfort. Some babies are more active and curious; others are more cautious. Some are easy-going, and others are more difficult to soothe. While babies are born with natural temperamental patterns, these are influenced by social experiences, particularly relationships with primary caregivers. In the early years of life, children's conflict revolves around their basic needs, their behaviour, and following parental instructions. Temperaments play an important role here which are biological dispositions that define the nature of the child in early years.



### Activity 04: Conflict Resolution (30 minutes)

#### Instructions

- Divide the participants into four groups.
- Read aloud or provide each group with a printout of the scenario given in the facilitator's notes.
- Ask the groups to discuss the following:
  - How both the children would be feeling?
  - Find a constructive solution to the conflict.
- Later each group will share their solutions with the large group.
- Further, explore conflict resolution dynamics in a child-friendly context. Emphasizing the importance of communication, empathy and finding mutually agreeable solutions.
- Discuss conflict resolution with the help of the facilitator's notes.

### Facilitator's Notes

#### Scenario

Ahad arrived at the playground first and has been playing on the swing for a short time. He wants to continue using it meanwhile Tahir arrives and wants to use the swing immediately. He feels disappointed and frustrated when Ahad doesn't willingly give up the swing leading to a disagreement over who should have the access.

**Conflict Resolution:** is a process of addressing and finding solution to disputes, disagreements, or conflict between person or groups. It involves defining the underlying issues, understanding different perspectives, and working collaboratively to reach a mutually agreeable solution. The goal of conflict resolution is to promote understanding, communication and cooperation, thereby preventing the escalation of conflicts and fostering positive relationships.

#### Activity 06: Reason for Conflict Resolution (40 minutes)

##### Instructions

- Divide the participants into groups.
- Ask them to talk about the questions given below in groups.
- Instruct them to discuss and note the important points on the flipchart.
- Invite the groups to present their work in the large group.
  - What are the common conflicts in the early years?
  - How do the parents react to the conflicts faced by children in their early years?
  - What steps can be taken to resolve conflicts among young children?
- Discuss the common conflict reasons and steps of conflict resolution among children shared in the facilitator's notes.

*Notes: Explain the questions and provide support to the participants of group two for completing the task.*

##### Facilitator's Notes

It is not uncommon for conflicts to arise between parents and children due to differences in expectations. This is especially true if parents do not fully understand their child's nature. Oftentimes, parents compare their children to others, which can increase conflict. During the toddler years, children are naturally curious explorers and are constantly on the move. They may run, jump, and climb throughout the day. Some parents may become concerned and label their child as hyperactive if they do not understand that this behaviour is quite normal. On the other hand, if a toddler is lethargic and not active, parents should be concerned.

Another source of conflict between parents and children is their ability to follow instructions. During this stage, parents often guide their children in managing their daily routines, such as brushing their teeth, organizing their room, going to school, watching TV, and socializing with peers. If a child is not following instructions, parents should first find out the reason for this behaviour before labelling them as stubborn or ill-mannered. For example, a child may be distracted by the TV or a favourite game, making it difficult for them to focus on the instructions. In this case, parents should remove the distraction before giving instructions. Another reason may be due to a child's lack of receptive language skills. In this case,



parents should give precise and brief instructions to ensure that the child can accomplish the task without becoming frustrated. It is often difficult for young children to understand and follow multiple instructions for example turn off the TV, go to your room and bring me your book and shoes. Here the child is expected to move in different directions and handle various objects. Some part of these instructions may not be carried out to the parent's satisfaction. Before issuing such instructions, parents should make simple requests or make sure that the child is able to handle multiple level instructions.

If a child is becoming defiant or argumentative, parents need to have open and honest conversations with them to resolve conflicts. It is also important for parents and children to clearly define rules that serve both their needs. Labeling and calling children bad names will only exacerbate conflicts. By pinpointing the reasons for conflicts and working together to find solutions, parents can build stronger relationships with their children.



### Parents and caregivers can guide children in concrete resolution using the following steps.

1. Position yourself between children, maintain eye level, and **use a calm tone** and gentle touch. Remain neutral without taking sides.
2. **Acknowledge the children's feelings.** Express empathy, like saying, "You seem upset." if the conflict involves an object inform the children that you'll hold it temporarily.
3. **Gather information** by asking, "What's the problem? Avoid using "Why" questions.
4. **Restate the problems.** Say, "So the problem is....". Utilize and expand on the children's vocabulary, substituting neutral words for hurtful or judgmental ones if necessary.
5. **Ask for ideas for solutions** and choose one together. Encourage the children to brainstorm solutions, providing options if needed.
6. **Be prepared to offer follow-up support.** Acknowledge the children's effort, saying, "You solve the problem." Stay close in case anyone is dissatisfied with the solution requiring a repeat of the process.

### Activity 07: Common Behavioural Problems (45 minutes)

#### Instructions

- Divide the participants into groups.
- Provide each group with a flipchart and ask them to make three columns on it.
- Ask them to write the following in each column:
  - In the first column, make them write what are the common behavioural problems they observe in their children.
  - In the second column, make them write why the mentioned behavioural problem occurs and what are its potential causes.

- In the third column, ask them to write how, as parents/ caregivers, they can resolve the problem and what kind of necessary support can be provided to resolve the mentioned behavioural issue.
- As the participants finish, ask them to pick any of the behavioral problems they have written about and prepare a short role-play to present their work to the large group.
- Invite the groups to come in front and present their role-play.
- Create discussion around each group's role-play and encourage the participants to share other problems they have mentioned that have not been discussed so far.
- Conclude the discussion by sharing the ideas given in the facilitator's notes.

### Facilitator's Notes

One of the major challenges of parenting is dealing with behavioural problems in children. Behavioural problems lead to negative consequences in healthy child development. Internalizing behavioural problems may lead to mental health issues like anxiety, loneliness, depression, suicidal thoughts, etc. Externalizing behavioural problems leads to antisocial behaviours, conduct disorder, self-harm, aggression, bullying, etc. Both internalizing and externalizing problems can be dealt with through effective parenting techniques.

### Responding to Problem Behaviours in Early Years

Here are a few strategies for parents to respond to problem behaviours in their children:

- Resist the temptation to end your child's anger by giving her/him what he/ she wants back, she explodes. This tells him/ her that tantrums work.
- Learn to remain calm in response to your child's behaviour.
- Use positive reinforcement to encourage good behaviour.
- Set clear boundaries and enforce consequences for breaking them.
- Teach your child problem-solving skills.
- Encourage your child to express their feelings and thoughts.
- Provide your child with a safe and stable environment.
- Take care of your children's safety, nutrition, play, and homework requirements. This will help them to show fewer negative behaviours.
- Providing them with organized and scheduled work routines will also help them to learn discipline.
- The child should also know what is expected from him, it will help to do the assigned tasks and avoid misunderstandings.



### Activity 08: Intolerance and Incivility (30 minutes)

#### Instructions

- On a board/ flipchart, write the words intolerance and incivility in a bubble.
- Ask the participants to share whatever comes to their mind thinking of these two words.
- Invite the participants to write their responses on the board/ flipchart.
- Once done, discuss the terms along with how these aspects can be prevented in children with the help of the facilitator's notes.

*Note: Write the responses of participants of group two on the board/ flipchart.*

#### Facilitator's Notes

**Intolerance** is the lack of tolerance, unwillingness, or refusal to tolerate or respect contrary opinions or beliefs, persons of different races or backgrounds, etc.

**Incivility** refers to disrespectful or rude behaviour, actions, or speech that violate social norms and often cause discomfort.



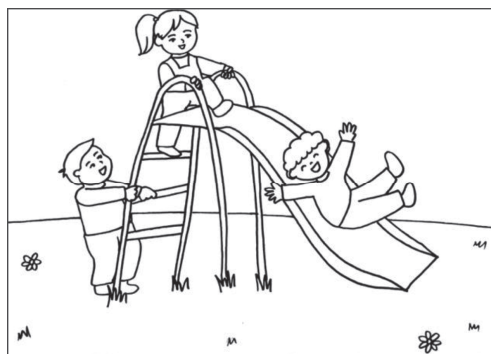
#### Strategies to Prevent Intolerance and Incivility in Children

The following techniques could be used with children to minimize intolerance and incivility in children:

**1. Preschool Enrichment Skills.** It aims to increase children's school preparedness and chances of academic success by providing them with early academic and social skills. Preschool enrichment skills attempt to prepare children for school by providing them with academic and social skills at an early age, thus increasing their chances of educational and social success (Krug, 2002). The content of such skills is diverse and can range from language development to raising self-esteem, problem-solving, empathy, and the development of literacy and numeracy skills.



**2. Social Development Skills.** It seeks to provide children with social and emotional skills to solve problems, empathize, and deal with conflict. Social development skills tend to promote prosocial behaviour and aim to prevent aggression in children by fostering social skills such as anger management, moral development, empathy, developing and maintaining healthy relationships, problem-solving, and conflict resolution.



**3. Academic Enrichment Skills.** Academic enrichment skills aim to improve children's academic achievement and school involvement by supporting their studies and offering recreational activities outside normal school hours. Low academic achievement and truancy are risk factors for violence; hence parents can play a pivotal role in improving children's academic performance and school attendance as the potential to reduce involvement in violence.



### Activity 09: Self-Reliance (30 minutes)

#### Instructions

- Ask participants the following questions. (one by one)
- Encourage them to share their experience.
  - Which activity does your child enjoy doing on their own?
  - Do you provide any kind of support in doing that activity?
  - What kind of support do you provide and why?
  - What happened when the child attempted that activity/ task for the first time?
  - How did they feel about it?
- Discuss the concept of building a self-reliant attitude in the children and cover the following concept mentioned in the facilitator's notes.

#### Facilitator's Notes

Developing self-reliance in children is an important aspect of teaching them life skills that are necessary for self-care and independence. Here are some tips to help your child become more self-sufficient and learn the skills they need to take care of themselves:

1. Give your child age-appropriate responsibilities around the house. It's important to break these responsibilities down into small, easy-to-understand steps so that your child can complete them successfully.
2. Let your child make mistakes and learn from them. This will teach them the invaluable lesson of rewards and consequences and build resilience.

3. Do some prep work if your child needs a little help with a task or is too young to complete the whole thing by themselves.
4. Teach problem-solving skills by offering clues instead of solutions when your child comes to you with a problem. Be available to help them brainstorm but avoid giving them an answer outright.
5. Some children may struggle with time management, so structuring their time can help them understand it better.
6. To reinforce character traits for kids, parents can use praise wisely. Whenever more specific praise can be given, it is more valuable for a child.



### Activity 10: Personal Strengths (20 minutes)

#### Instructions

- Provide the participants with a blank A-4 size sheet.
- Ask the participants to think and list down their strengths and the possible ways in which these strengths could be used.

**Notes:** For group two participants, the responses can be verbally shared, and the facilitator can note them down for them on the flipchart. Also, the participants can be encouraged to draw their responses if they wish.

### Key Takeaways Relationship Skills

- Relationship skills are the abilities and techniques that individuals use to develop various relationships and facilitate effective communication and support.
- Relationship skills are essential in promoting the well-being, growth, and problem-resolution of individuals facing common life challenges.
- Conflict resolution promotes understanding and cooperation which prevent the escalation of conflicts and foster positive relationships.
- Temperament refers to individual characteristics that influence how we react emotionally, cognitively, and physically in various situations.

### 4.3. Civic Sense and Responsible Citizenship

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| <b>Name of the Session</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Civic Sense and Responsible Citizenship |
| <b>Time</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | 135 minutes                             |
| <b>Learning Outcomes</b><br>By the end of this session, participants will be able to: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Identify strategies to prepare children to assume citizen roles in the community.</li> <li>• Develop an understanding of active and positive citizenship in young children</li> <li>• Recognise the skills which are essential for inducing a sense of civic responsibility in children.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                         |
| <b>Session Resources/ Materials</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Powerpoint slides / Charts with the content</li> <li>• Basic stationery</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                         |
| <b>Concept/Themes to be Covered</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Civic responsibility and ownership</li> <li>• Developing a participatory role in the community</li> <li>• Social and community development</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                         |
| <b>Activity 1: Civic Sense (40 minutes)</b><br><br><b>Instructions</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Ask the participants given questions.               <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ What do you understand from the terms “Civic sense” and “civic engagement”?</li> <li>○ Do you like to educate and engage your children in civic affairs/ social activities?</li> <li>○ What are the challenges in your areas to involve your children in such activities?</li> </ul> </li> <li>• Take some responses from the participants and discuss the importance of civic engagement from an early age with the help of the facilitator’s notes.</li> </ul><br><b>Facilitator’s Notes</b><br>Children can engage in civic activities and responsible citizenship for various reasons. Encouraging such engagement from a young age can help them develop into informed, active, and responsible members of their communities and society as a whole. Here are some reasons why children should engage in civic activities and responsible citizenship. Explain these while relating these to contextual examples: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Sense of belonging</li> <li>• Empowerment</li> <li>• Values and ethics</li> <li>• Education through practical experiences</li> <li>• Social responsibility</li> </ul> |                                         |

- Problem-solving skills
- Leadership skills
- Critical thinking
- Respect for diversity
- Preparation for adulthood
- Moral development
- Family and community values
- Personal fulfilment

It is important to acknowledge the participation of children in the community. They often work under direct supervision or in collaboration with adults. Their involvement in community development is crucial for two reasons. Firstly, it ensures that their opinions are heard by authorities whose decisions affect them. Secondly, their participation can lead to positive changes in their local community and schools.

### Activity 2: Community Mapping (60 minutes)

#### Instructions

- Divide the participants into small groups.
- Provide markers and chart paper to each group.
- Ask participants to create a poster of their community highlighting places of importance and areas for improvement.
- Each group will share their work in a large group.
- Explain to the participants that civic responsibilities play a crucial role in enhancing community well-being. When people actively engage in their civic duties and responsibilities, it contributes to the overall health, harmony, and prosperity of the community.

### Activity 3: Sense of Community Responsibility (20 minutes)

#### Instructions

- Ask participants to think for a minute and make a list of the ways to inculcate civic responsibilities in young children.
- Take responses from the participants and write on the whiteboard.
- Share a list of activities mentioned in the facilitator's notes that can be done with the children.

#### Facilitator's Notes

Engaging children in activities related to civic sense and responsible citizenship can help instil positive values and a sense of community responsibility. Below are some activities that parents, and caregivers do with children.

- Identify community helper.

- Go for a walk and observe positive actions. Discuss their findings and ask why they think it's positive.
- Tell stories that highlight civic sense and responsible citizenship.
- Making thank you cards for community helpers.
- Plantation
- Make art projects with recycled material.
- Create and follow a good manners chart.
- Follow traffic rules.

#### Activity 4: Making the World a Better Place (15 minutes)

##### Instructions

- Ask participants to draw a tree with four branches and label each branch with the following themes:
  - What kind of values and morals would you like to teach your children?
  - What positive influences would you like your child to be exposed to? And How would you achieve this?
  - What kind of negative influences or harmful forces would you like to protect your child from?
  - If you could change one thing to make the world a better place for your child, what would that be?
- Ask participants to display their charts and all participants will have a gallery walk.

#### Key Takeaways: Civic Sense and Responsible Citizen

- Civic responsibilities promote a sense of belonging and shared identity within the community.
- Fulfilling civics responsibilities such as following traffic rules, and reporting suspicious activities, contributes to a safer community environment.
- Civic responsibilities related to environmental conservation, waste reduction, and sustainable practices contribute to a healthier and more sustainable community, benefiting both current and future generations.
- In times of crisis or emergencies, a community with engaged and responsible citizens is better equipped to respond effectively.

- Learning about civic responsibilities helps children understand that along with rights come responsibilities.
- Encouraging children to actively participate in community activities such as clean-up events or instills a sense of duty and demonstrates the positive impact of their contribution.
- Starting early with civic responsibilities lays the foundation for a lifelong commitment to community engagement and responsible citizenship.
- Children who actively contribute to their community develop a sense of pride in their civic identity, understanding the importance of being responsible.

| 4.4 Building Bridges of Peace                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>Name of the Session</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Building Bridges of Peace |
| <b>Time</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | 120 minutes               |
| <b>Learning Outcomes</b><br>By the end of the session, participants will be able to: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Enhance understanding of the importance of peacebuilding within the family and community.</li> <li>• Develop skills to counter conflicts through positive communication, empathy, and conflict resolution.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                           |
| <b>Session Resources/ Materials</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• PowerPoint slides/ charts with the content</li> <li>• Basic Stationery</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                           |
| <b>Concept/ Themes to be covered</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Introduction to Peace Building and conflict resolution</li> <li>• Peace-building concepts that apply within family dynamics and can extend to community interactions.</li> <li>• Fostering a peaceful home environment.</li> <li>• Effectiveness of different approaches, emphasizing non-violent communication, empathy, and understanding.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                           |
| <b>Introduction to Peacebuilding and Conflict Resolution: (40 Minutes)</b><br>Welcome participants to the session “Building Bridges of Peace”, and give a brief overview of the session.<br><b>Activity 1: Large Group Activity:</b> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• After the introduction, invite the participants to share their understanding of the questions below.               <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>○ What do you know about peacebuilding and conflict resolution?</li> <li>○ How can we foster peacebuilding initiatives in our society/environment?</li> </ul> </li> <li>• Take some responses from the large group and note down the main ideas on the whiteboard/flip chart.</li> </ul> |                           |

**Instructions:****After a large group discussion, the facilitator will**

- Deliver a brief presentation on the concepts of peacebuilding and the importance of countering violent extremism.
- Discuss how these concepts apply within family dynamics and can extend to community interactions.

Explain how fostering a peaceful home environment can contribute to broader societal peace.

**Facilitator Notes:**

- **Active Listening:** Active listening involves fully concentrating, understanding, responding, and remembering what is being said.
  - **Techniques:**
    - Pay Attention: Show that you are listening through eye contact and nodding.
    - Reflect: Paraphrase what the speaker has said to show understanding.
    - Clarify: Ask questions to ensure you understand the message.
    - Summarize: Recap the main points to confirm understanding.
- **Empathy:** Empathy is the ability to understand and share the feelings of another person.
  - **Techniques:**
    - Perspective-Taking: Try to see the situation from the other person's point of view.
    - Validation: Acknowledge the other person's feelings and experiences.
    - Non-Judgmental: Avoid making judgments or assumptions about the other person.
- **Emotional Regulation:** Emotional regulation involves managing and responding to emotions healthily.
  - **Techniques:**
    - Deep Breathing: Use deep breathing exercises to calm down when feeling stressed or angry.
    - Mindfulness: Practice mindfulness to stay present and aware of your emotions.
    - Pause: Take a moment to pause and think before reacting to a situation.

- **Non-Violent Communication:** Non-violent communication is a method of communicating that focuses on expressing feelings and needs without blame or criticism.
  - **Techniques:**
    - Observation: State the facts without judgment.
    - Feelings: Express your feelings clearly.
    - Needs: Communicate your needs without making demands.
    - Requests: Make clear, actionable requests.
- **Problem-solving:** Problem-solving involves finding solutions to conflicts or issues constructively.
  - **Techniques:**
    - Identify the Problem: Clearly define the issue at hand.
    - Brainstorm Solutions: Generate multiple possible solutions.
    - Evaluate Options: Assess the pros and cons of each solution.
    - Implement and Review: Choose the best solution and evaluate its effectiveness.
- **Mediation:** Mediation is a process where a neutral third party helps resolve conflicts between two or more parties.
  - **Techniques:**
    - Neutrality: Remain neutral and impartial.
    - Facilitation: Guide the discussion to ensure all parties have a chance to speak.
    - Agreement: Help the parties reach a mutually acceptable agreement.
- **Conflict Resolution:** Conflict resolution involves methods and processes for resolving a disagreement or conflict.
  - **Techniques:**
    - Collaborative Approach: Work together to find a solution that satisfies all parties.
    - Compromise: Find a middle ground where each party gives up something.
    - Accommodating: One party gives in to the wishes of the other.
    - Avoiding: Delay dealing with the conflict until a better time.

- **Cultural Sensitivity:** Cultural sensitivity involves being aware and respectful of cultural differences.
  - **Techniques:**
    - Learn: Educate yourself about different cultures and traditions.
    - Respect: Show respect for cultural practices and beliefs.
    - Open-Mindedness: Be open to different perspectives and ways of life.
- **Peace Building Activities:** Activities designed to promote peace, understanding, and cooperation.
  - **Techniques:**
    - Role-Playing Scenarios: Practice resolving conflicts through roleplaying.
    - Group Discussions: Facilitate open discussions on peace and conflict resolution.
    - Workshops: Conduct workshops on communication skills and emotional intelligence.

### **Role Play scenarios and feedback:**

#### **Activity 2: Small Group Activity – Role Play: (40 Minutes)**

##### **Instructions:**

- Divide participants into small groups (4 to 5 participants in each group) with the following instructions.
- Ask each group to develop a scenario that describes a potential conflict situation either within the family or in the community.
- Ask each group to prepare the group for role play based on the scenario
- Give 5 minutes to prepare role play and 5 minutes for demonstration.
- Each group will demonstrate the scenario through role-play, first as it typically might unfold, and then using strategies from the peace-building from the facilitator notes. Encourage creativity and exploration of different resolution techniques.

#### **Group Discussion and Feedback (30 minutes)**

After concluding role plays, bring all participants together for group discussion and feedback focusing on the creativity and exploration of different resolution techniques. In group discussion, each group will share the resolution that they choose for their respective scenario. The facilitator will facilitate the discussion on the effectiveness of different approaches, emphasizing non-violent communication, empathy, and understanding.

**Commitment Cards (10 minutes)****Activity 3: Individual Activity****Instruction:**

Regarding commitment cards, share the following instructions with the participants.

- Distribute post-it notes or small cards to all participants.
- Ask them to write a personal commitment, to how they will promote peace and counter violent extremism in their environment.
- Collect the cards and post them on a "Commitment Wall" or keep them private, based on participant preference.

At the end of the session, the facilitator will summarize the key learnings from the activity. Encourage ongoing communication among participants to support each other in implementing their peace commitments. The facilitator will share with the participants that, this activity is designed to be engaging and transformative, helping them to apply peacebuilding concepts actively in their daily lives, thereby fostering environments that resist violent extremism and promote mutual understanding and respect.

**Key takeaways Building Bridges of Peace**

- Use active listening and empathy in everyday conversations.
- Practice non-violent communication with family members and colleagues.
- Apply problem-solving and mediation techniques during disputes.
- Use emotional regulation strategies to manage stress and anger.
- Organize peace-building activities and workshops in your community.
- Promote cultural sensitivity and understanding through community events.

## Epilogue

As we come to the end of this learning experience, we hope that our participants have been able to reflect on their journeys of parenthood of children from prenatal to nine years of age. Throughout this Manual, we explored different key concepts and each required adaptability, patience, and unconditional love from parents and caregivers for strong bonding. Implicit within the concepts and discussions have been the pointers for effective parenting hidden in the Aghosh acronym **A**ttachment, **G**uidance, **H**onesty, **O**pportunities for learning, **S**afety and **S**upport, **H**appy and **H**eady childhood.

Reiterating the key teachings gleaned from the Nurturing Care Framework bears repetition. Parenthood revolving around providing good health, ensuring adequate nutrition, offering opportunities for early learning, ensuring the safety and security of the children while practicing responsive caregiving will go a long way to fulfilling the promise that is childhood.

In the end, it is important to remember that each child is unique and brings a whole new plethora of talents, personal qualities, perspectives, and areas of improvement. Parents' and caregivers' job is to polish their talent and provide space to grow into unique individuals.

**AGHOSH for Me**

Think about your overall learning and note down points in the following table. Write as many as you want...

|          | <b>My learning</b> |
|----------|--------------------|
| <b>A</b> |                    |
| <b>G</b> |                    |
| <b>H</b> |                    |
| <b>O</b> |                    |
| <b>S</b> |                    |
| <b>H</b> |                    |

**Feedback form:**

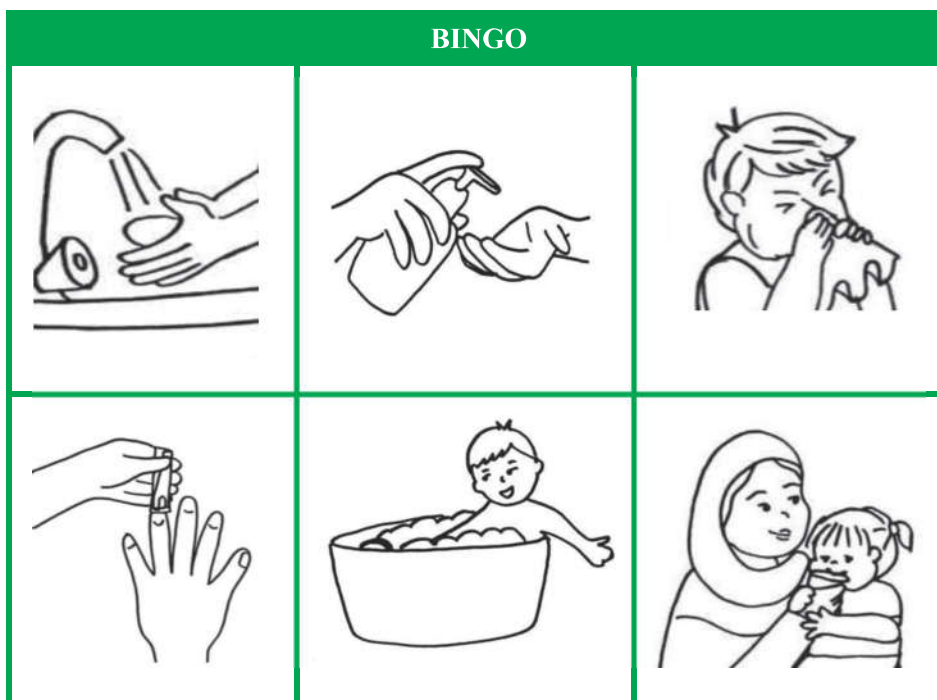
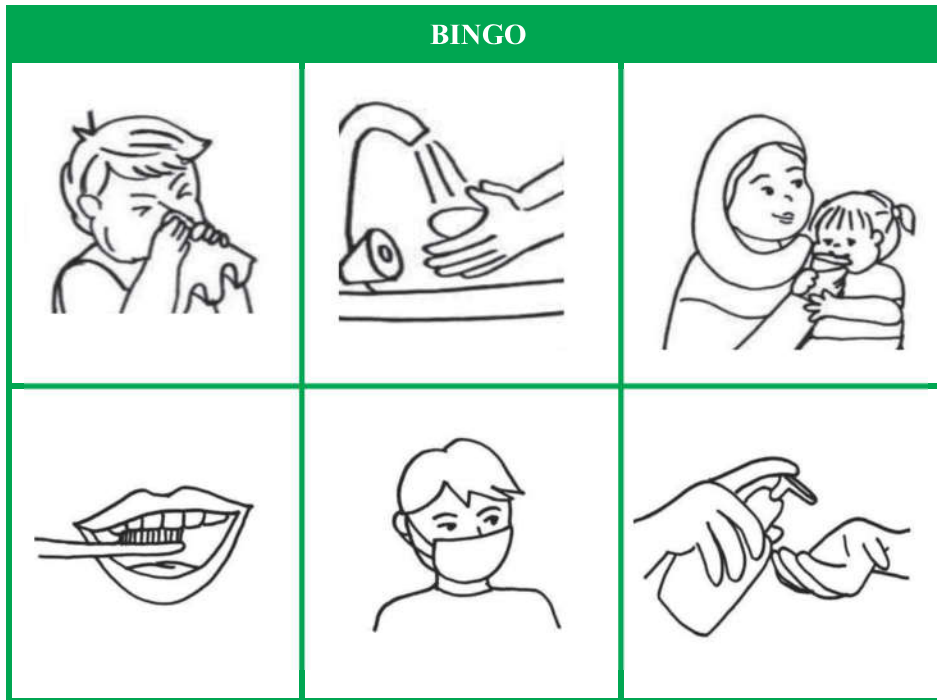
Dear Participants, complete this feedback form. For each question, use the symbols provided to rate your experience:

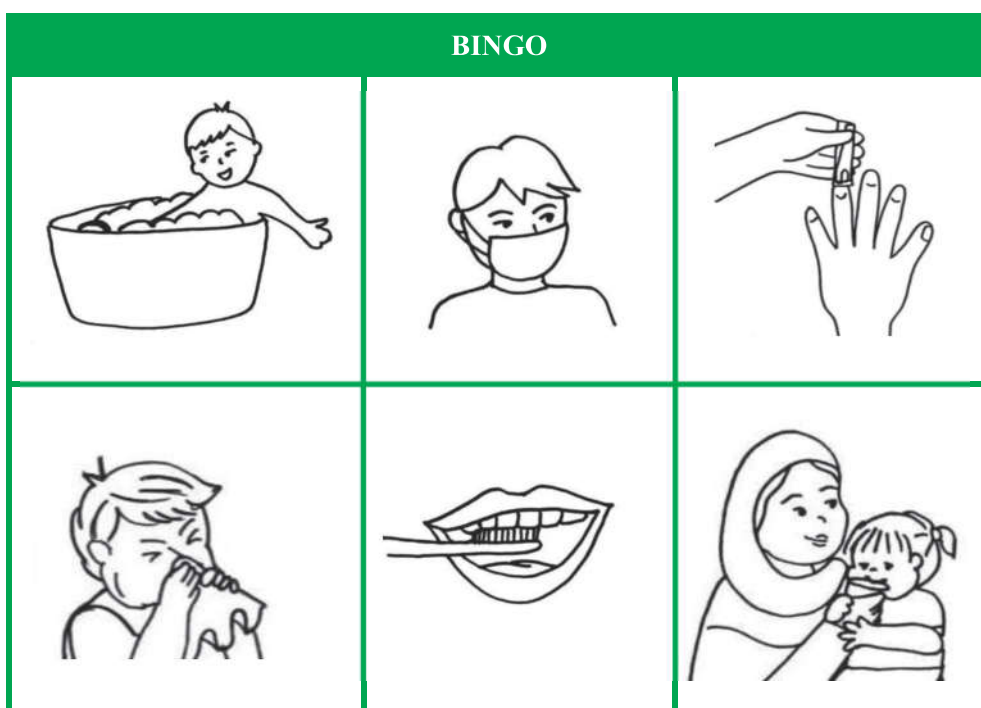
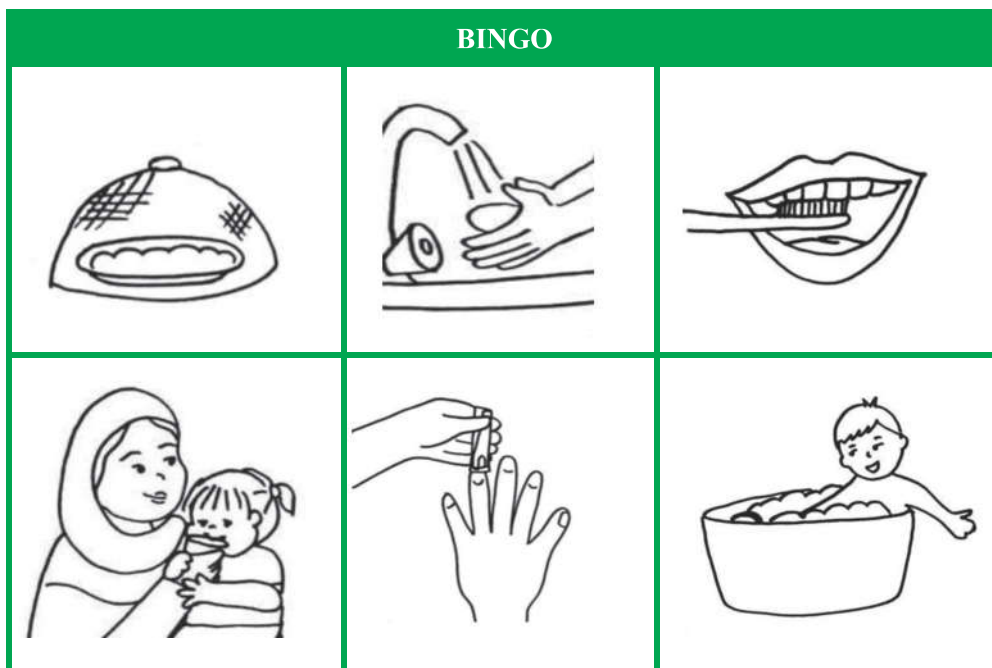
| Symbol                                                                                    | Description                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
|  Happy   | You are satisfied with this aspect of the session      |
|  Neutral | You feel neutral with this aspect of the session.      |
|  Sad     | You are not satisfied with this aspect of the session. |

| S. No. | Statement                                                                             |  |  |  |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1      | The session effectively met its stated objectives                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| 2      | The session was engaging and interactive.                                             |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| 3      | The concepts presented were clear and understandable.                                 |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| 4      | The examples and scenarios were contextually relevant.                                |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| 5      | There were opportunities for participation and discussion.                            |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| 6      | The strategies and tools provided were useful.                                        |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| 7      | The session duration was appropriate                                                  |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| 8      | The facilitator's knowledge and delivery were satisfactory.                           |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| 9      | I can apply the knowledge and skills learned in this session to real-life situations. |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |
| 10     | The session met my expectations.                                                      |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |                                                                                     |

## Appendix A

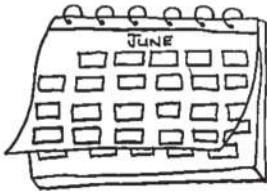
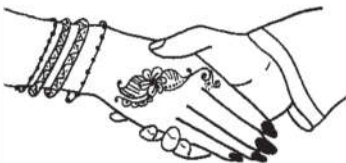
## Hygiene Bingo Card





## Appendix B

## Bingo- Developmental Domains

| Find someone who....                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Check Facebook Daily!</b><br>                | <b>Has a birthday in June?</b><br> | <b>Can sew a button on a shirt</b><br> |
| <b>Has seen mountains!</b><br>                 | <b>Has a little brother!</b><br>  | <b>Wears glasses!</b><br>              |
| <b>Had been married for over 5 years.</b><br> | <b>Loves to travel!</b><br>      | <b>Likes to cook!</b><br>            |

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[s\\_lcrp=EgZjaHJvbWUyBggAEEUYOTIGCAEQRRg80gEIMTE5NmowajSoAgCwAgA&sourceid=chrome&ie=UTF-8](https://www.verywellfamily.com/definition-of-domain-3288323)

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